OPEN LETTER · EYE ON SHOALHAVEN COUNCIL

Steve Prothero asks Casmiri and Mayor White to disclose SIG's current membership numbers

Sent 21 July 2026 · To Cr Casmiri, Mayor White · Response requested by 11 August 2026

boundary="Apple-Mail=_8D77E4C6-69D8-463D-95C1-FC40DADFF217" charset=us-ascii charset=utf-8 21 July 2026 Letter to Cr Luciano Casmiri and Mayor Patricia White RE: Disclosure of the Shoalhaven Independents Group's Current Membership Numbers Dear Cr Casmiri and Mayor White, I write with a single, narrow request, separate from the broader questions raised in my letter to the Mayor of 21 July 2026. The Grattan Institute's April 2026 report on Australian democracy, For the People , recommends that Australian political parties publish their current membership numbers, on the basis that transparency of this kind helps rebuild public trust and encourages parties to broaden their base. The Shoalhaven Independents Group is a political party registered with the NSW Electoral Commission, with its own registered officers â€ it is not an informal grouping of independents, and this recommendation applies to it as directly as to any state or federal party. I address this letter to both of you because you are, between you, best placed to answer it. Cr Casmiri, you are one of SIG's three registered party officers, and hold that role alongside your seat on this Council. Mayor White, you are SIG's leader. Neither of you needs to consult a committee to state a number that either of you should already know. The request is simply this: how many current, financial members does the Shoalhaven Independents Group have, as at today's date? I recognise there is no existing legal obligation on a locally registered party to disclose this figure, and I am not asserting that there is one. This is a request made on the same grounds Grattan sets out â€ that residents who are asked to trust a governing majority's mandate are entitled to know the base it claims to represent, particularly where that party holds seven of thirteen seats on this Council. A number is a fact, not a policy position, and I don't think it should require weeks of deliberation to provide one. I will report on whatever response, if any, is received, and will note plainly if the figure is provided, declined, or simply not answered. Yours faithfully, Steve Prothero Publisher, Eye on Shoalhaven Council filename=smime.p7s name=smime.p7s

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